

WHAT IS PSYCHOLOGY

Psychology is the scientific study of the mind and behavior encompassing both conscious and unconscious mental processes, thoughts, feelings and motivations of human and other organisms.

- Focus On the mind and behavior: Psychology primarily investigates how people think, feel and act.

- Scientific approach: It uses research methods to study and understand those mental processes.

- Broad Scope: Psychology examine both conscious and unconscious aspects of the mind.

KEY ASPECT OF PSYCHOLOGISTS IMPORTANCE TO SOCIETY

1 MENTAL HEALTH SUPPORT

Psychologists diagnose and treat mental health conditions like depression, anxiety and addiction, improving individual quality of life and overall well-being.

2 Relationship Improvement

Understanding psychological factors influencing relationships helps individuals build strong connections with family, friends and partners.

3 EDUCATIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Applying psychological principles in education can lead to more effective teaching methods, better student learning outcome and addressing behavioral issues in classrooms.

4 WORKPLACE PRODUCTIVITY

Understanding employee motivation, stress management and team dynamics through psychology can enhance workplace productivity and employee satisfaction.

5 SOCIAL POLICY DEVELOPMENT

Psychological research informs policies related to healthcare, crime prevention and community development, addressing societal issues at a broader level.

6 CONSUMERS BEHAVIOR ANALYSIS

Marketing and advertising heavily rely on psychological insights to understand consumer motivation and design effective campaigns.

7 CRISIS INTERVENTION

Psychologists play a vital role in providing support and intervention during times of crisis such as natural disasters or large scale trauma.

THE FOUR MAIN GOALS OF PSYCHOLOGY

1 DESCRIBE BEHAVIOR
Is explaining how someone or something acts. It involves observing and measuring actions, reactions, and habits to understand patterns and motivations.

2 EXPLAIN BEHAVIOR

Refers to the aim of understanding why people act the way they do by identifying the underlying factors, motivations and influences that contribute to a particular behavior, essentially seeking to answer the 'why' behind someone's actions.

3 PREDICT BEHAVIOR

Making predictions about how humans think and act is the third goal of psychology. By looking at past observed behavior (describing and explaining), psychologists aim to predict when or if others might exhibit the same behavior. By predicting behavioral patterns, psychologists may also understand their underlying causes in theory. A prediction could give psychologists the ability to help change or control behavior.

CHANGE & CONTROL

Psychology often aims to change influence, or control behavior to make positive, constructive meaningful and lasting changes in people's lives.

- In the case where a client performs an action they feel guilty for that harmed themselves or others a psychologist might approach the action with the following question
- What happened? (Describing)
 - Why did you do that? (Explaining)
 - What would happen again? (Predicting)
 - What can you do next time to reach a more positive outcome? (Changing)

THE DEVELOPMENT OF PSYCHOLOGY AS EFFORT TO UNDERSTAND HUMAN BEHAVIOR.

The development of psychology as an effort to understand human behavior traces its roots back to ancient philosophers like ~~Plato~~ and Aristotle who pondered the mind and behavior but it formally emerged as a scientific discipline in the late 19th Century with Wilhelm Wundt establishing the first psychology laboratory, marking the beginning of experimental psychology focused on studying consciousness through introspection; they developments included the rise of psychoanalysis by Sigmund Freud emphasizing the unconscious mind, behaviorism by John B. Watson and B.F. Skinner focusing on observable actions, humanistic psychology by Carl Rogers and Abraham Maslow highlighting personal growth, and cognitive psychology exploring mental processes like memory and thinking with the field continuing to evolve and incorporate diverse perspectives and new technologies to better understand human behavior ^{Complexities} ~~Complexities~~.

KEY POINTS IN THE TIMELINE

ANCIENT PHILOSOPHY (GREECE, EGYPT, CHINA):

Early inquiries into the mind and behavior by philosophers like Plato and Aristotle laid the foundation for later psychological exploration.

17th CENTURY: RENE DESCARTES.

Introduced the concept of mind-body dualism, separating the mind from the ~~psyched~~ body, which influenced early psychology.

LATE 19th CENTURY: WILHELM WUNDT.
Considered the "father of psychology" established the first psychology laboratory in Leipzig, Germany and promoted the study of consciousness through introspection.

EARLY 20th CENTURY: SIGMUND FREUD.
Developed psychoanalysis, emphasizing the role of the unconscious mind in shaping behavior, including concepts like the id, ego and superego.

EARLY 20th CENTURY: BEHAVIORISM:
led by John B. Watson and B.F. Skinner focused on studying observable behaviors and conditioning, rejecting the study of internal ~~mental~~ ^{internal} H

Mental State

MID-20th CENTURY: HUMANISTIC PSYCHOLOGY

Advocated by Carl Rogers and Abraham Maslow, emphasizing personal growth, self-actualization, and positive aspects of human nature.

MID-TO-LATE 20th CENTURY: COGNITIVE PSYCHOLOGY
Focused on mental processes like memory, perception, and language, exploring how people think and process information.

METHODS OF STUDY HUMAN BEHAVIOUR

1. INTROSPECTION METHOD

This method was introduced by E.B. Titchener. This is also known as self-observation method. Introspection means to look within.

It is not possible to understand the inner feelings and experiences of other persons. But the individual himself can observe and report.

Example: A patient can report about his pain and other disturbances in a better way than by a nurse. He may write within himself and explain how he is feeling. This will help for a better treatment. Though introspection is a useful method, it has some demerits also. These are.

a) He cannot verify the response given by the observer hence we have to accept his report. At times even if he is reporting correctly there may be alterations.

b) This method cannot be used to study children, animals and persons suffering from mental disorders, but this is a cheap and easy method.

2. OBSERVATION METHOD:-

This method is very useful in the areas where experiments cannot be conducted. In this method observer will observe and collect the data.

Example:- In the hospital the nurse will make observation of patient's temperature, pulse, BP, facial expressions, etc.
Hence 5

This method is very useful to study the children, mentally ill animals and unconscious patients. At times the observer will go to the natural settings situations etc in order to get the objective data.

Because in natural settings the person being observed will not be aware that he is being observed, his behaviour will be natural/original. Hence, this method is also known as 'naturalistic observation' or 'objective observation' method. This is a very good and useful method. But the disadvantages are

a) There are chances of subjective reports, and prejudices of observer may creep in. Sometimes to observe the natural behaviour the observer may have to spend more time, energy and money.

3. EXPERIMENTAL METHOD

This is the most objective way of studying the behaviour. In this method, experiments are conducted in the laboratories under controlled conditions. In experiments, usually the effect of independent variable on the dependent variable is studied.

Hence, there will be two variables, viz, independent and dependent variable. There will be some other variables which are not related by the experimenters, and their interference may affect the results of the experiment. Such variables are to be controlled.

These unwanted variables are called 'extraneous' or 'interfering' variables. Experiments are conducted under controlled conditions in order to control the effect of these extraneous variables. Examples: The effect of music on the level of blood pressure can be studied in the laboratory settings. Here the music is the independent variable and BP is dependent variable. All other sounds other than music are extraneous variables that are to be controlled so the effect of only music can be assessed. Similarly the effect of different drugs, food etc can also be studied.

Experiment may be ^{also} be conducted using two different groups called experimental group and control group.

APPEND B

and the control group is kept constant.

Otherwise, the experiment may be conducted on the same group under two conditions ~~viz~~, ~~experimented~~ ^{experimental} and controlled conditions.

- a Identification of the problem
- b Formulation of hypothesis
- c Designing the experiment
- d Testing the hypothesis by experiment
- e Analysis of results
- F Interpretation of results

The advantage of this method is that, the results of the experiment may be verified by repetition of the same experiment. But this method has some demerits also. They are:
a Conducting experiment is very expensive and time consuming.
b Another feature is that the experiments cannot be conducted outside the laboratory.

CASE HISTORY / CASE HISTORY METHOD

This method is used very commonly in hospitals and also in educational settings. In hospitals, when a patient is admitted, the nurse can collect the detailed information pertaining to the disease of the patient. The information includes the past history of the disease, treatment taken already, changes if any like improvement, present condition, probable causes, sign and symptoms etc. This information may be obtained from the patient, his close relatives like parents, siblings or others who accompany him or from his friends, neighbours etc.

DISCUSSION METHOD

This is used to gather the information from large number of people. Questionnaires, checklists, rating scales, inventories are used to collect the required information. This method is usually used to gather information about political opinion, customs, preferences, etc. It may also be used to know the information pertaining to medical profession - like awareness about diseases and medical programmes, malnutrition, opinions about health needs, health facilities available, etc.

Method 7

3. CROSS METHOD

This method is also known as developmental method. Most of our behaviours are the result of earlier experiences. In some cases when we need to understand some behaviour we need to know their developmental aspects also. For example, in order to understand the behaviour of adults we need to know their childhood development.

This can be done by two ways

- a. Cross sectional study in which the children of different age groups will be studied simultaneously
- b. Longitudinal study in which the same individual will be studied in different stages of life. This is more useful method to understand the behaviour from point of view of hereditary and environmental influences.

4. TESTS METHOD

Different tests are developed by psychologists to study various aspects of behaviour. The attitudes, interests, abilities, intelligence, adjustments, personality and such other factors which influence behaviour can be studied by administering the suitable tests.

THE INTERPLAY BETWEEN PSYCHOLOGY AND OTHER SOCIAL SCIENCES

Psychology, when compared to other social sciences, ^{forecast} ~~forecast~~ primarily on the individual mind and behaviour, while other disciplines like Sociology, anthropology, and political science tend to examine social structure, cultures, and political systems that influence individual actions, creating a strong interdependency where each field informs the other through shared research methods and theoretical frameworks, particularly within the area of "social psychology" which bridges the gap between individual and social dynamics; essentially,

psychology provides insights into individual behaviours that can help explain broader social phenomena studied by the social sciences.

^{Points}
Key point about the relationship between Psychology and Other Social Sciences.

- Focus on the individual vs. the group.

Psychology primarily examine individual thoughts, emotions, and behaviours while other social sciences focus on how those individual elements interact within social groups, institutions, and societies.

- Social Psychology as a bridge.

This subfield within psychology directly examine how social situations and interactions influence individual behaviour creating a strong link with sociology and other social sciences.

- Shared research methods.

Many social sciences utilize similar research methods like surveys, experiments and observation, allowing for cross-disciplinary collaboration and comparison.

- Specific

NEEDS FOR BEHAVIOR

In psychology, "motives for behavior" refers to the underlying reasons or driving forces behind a person's actions, which can include factors like the need for achievement, affiliation, power, intrinsic enjoyment, external rewards, curiosity, and the desire to fulfill basic need like safety and belonging; essentially, what compels someone to behave in a certain way.

- Key types of motives in psychology

INTRINSIC MOTIVATION: Driven by internal satisfaction and enjoyment from the activity itself, like pursuing a hobby for the love of it.

- EXTRINSIC MOTIVATION: Driven by external rewards or pressures like working for a bonus.

- NEED FOR ACHIEVEMENT: Desire to excel and accomplish goals.

- NEED FOR AFFILIATION: Desire to connect with others and build relationships.

- NEED FOR POWER: Desire to control or influence others.
- COGN COGNITIVE MOTIVES: Driven by the need to understand and process information, like curiosity.

• PROTIFORM BEHAVIOURS : Acting based on emotions like happiness, fear or anger.

• SOCIAL NORMS : Behaviours driven by the desire to fit in or be accepted by a group.

DEVELOPMENT OF BEHAVIOUR

Development of behaviour "refers to the process of how a persons actions, thoughts, and emotions change and evolve throughout their lifespan, from birth to adulthood, influenced by various factors like environment, experiences, and maturation; essentially it's the study of how our behaviour changes as we grow and learn over time.

• Key points about behaviour development Lifespan perspective.

This perspective views human behaviour as a continuous process of change that occurs throughout an individual's entire life, encompassing multiple domains like physical, cognitive, and social aspects, and is significantly influenced by the interplay between biological maturation, environmental factors, and personal experiences across different life stages; essentially, it emphasises that development is lifelong, multidimensional, plastic, and contextually dependent.

• MULTIPLE ASPECTS :

When analysing multiple aspects of behaviour in development, key areas to consider include : motor skills, cognitive abilities, social interaction, emotional regulation, language development, and sensory processing, all of which interact and influence each other as a person grows and learns throughout their life.

• INFLUENCING FACTORS

- This factors influencing behaviour in behavioural development can be categorized into biological genetic factors (including

Genetics and brain development), environmental factors (like family dynamics, social interactions, and culture), Psychological factors (such as emotions, cognition, and learning experiences), and personal factors (like age, gender, and individual personality traits) which all interact to shape an individual's behavior throughout their life.

COGNITIVE DEVELOPMENT:

Cognitive development is the process of growing and changing mental abilities, such as thinking, reasoning and understanding. It includes the ability to acquire and use knowledge.

Stages Of Cognitive development Sensory-motor Stage (birth to 2 years)

Infants learn primarily through sensory experiences and physical interactions with their environment, developing key concepts like object permanence (understanding that objects still exist even when hidden)

Preoperational Stage (2 to 7 years)

Children begin to use symbols and language to represent objects and ideas, but their thinking is often egocentric (difficulty seeing things from another person's perspective) and lacks logical reasoning.

Concrete Operational Stage (7 to 11 years)

Children can now think logically about concrete situations and understand concepts like conservation (quantity remains the same regardless of appearance changes) and perform simple mental operations.

Formal Operational Stage (11 years and beyond)

Adolescents develop the ability to think abstractly, reason hypothetically, and consider multiple possibilities, including complex problem-solving.